

Called up in the nation’s capital



JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON/AP

A tour bus passes members of the D.C. National Guard, mobilized by President Donald Trump, in Washington on Sunday. The number of troops in the city could nearly double in the coming days as Republican governors answered the administration’s call for additional personnel in a city Trump portrays as crime-ridden. **Story, A5**

U.S. ready to give Ukraine ‘robust’ security pledge

LAND CONCESSIONS SEEN AS KEY TO PEACE

European leaders to join Zelensky at White House

This article is by David L. Stern, Mariana Alfaro, Anastacia Galouchka, Catherine Belton and Natalie Allison

U.S. special envoy Steve Witkoff said Sunday ahead of a planned meeting at the White House with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky and European leaders that President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin agreed to “robust security guarantees” during their summit in Alaska last week.

“The United States is potentially prepared to be able to give Article 5 security guarantees, but not from NATO — directly from the United States and other European countries,” Witkoff said in a “Fox News Sunday” interview.

Under Article 5 of the NATO treaty, if a member country is attacked, each member of the alliance “will consider this act of violence as an armed attack against all members and will take the actions it deems necessary.” Ukraine is not a member of NATO but has been seeking support from allies since Russia launched

its full-scale invasion in 2022.

Witkoff said the security guarantee deal would be further discussed among the United States, Zelensky and European allies during the Monday afternoon meeting in Washington. European leaders will be joining that meeting to present a united front to help Zelensky navigate what Ukrainians anticipate could be a high-stakes and potentially emotional meeting on which Ukraine’s future could hinge.

Separately, the U.S. is hoping that a trilateral meeting with Trump, Putin and Zelensky will take place this week, according to a White House official. The official, however, cautioned that the White House does not necessarily expect Monday’s meeting to result in that. The official spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss internal planning.

Working out the precise implementation of security guarantees is likely to be a lengthy process, which could allow Putin to continue his war while details are finalized.

SEE UKRAINE ON A11

Mass protests erupt in Israel as military readies plans to occupy Gaza City

BY CLAIRE PARKER, HEIDI LEVINE, ALON ROM AND ABBIE CHEESEMAN

JERUSALEM — Hundreds of thousands of Israelis stayed home from work, flooded city streets, and blocked roads and highways across the country on Sunday, according to local media, staging some of the largest anti-war protests in months as the military

Demonstrations, strike call for end to war and release of last hostages

prepared for a major assault on Gaza City, the humanitarian crisis there deepened and anxiety mounted over the conditions of the hostages still in captivity.

The widespread strike on Sunday, a workday in Israel, was organized by the Hostages and Missing Families Forum, an umbrella group representing many families of current or former Israeli hostages. The group called for action in response to the government’s decision this month to seize control of Gaza’s largest city, an operation that could take months and involve the forced displacement of an

estimated 1 million Palestinians.

Senior military leaders and a growing number of Israeli citizens oppose the plan, worried that it would endanger the 20 hostages authorities presume are still alive, strain army resources and erode prospects for recovering the bodies of 30 more hostages who were either killed in the Hamas attacks on Oct. 7, 2023, or died in captivity. “Hundreds of thousands of Is-

raeli citizens will shut down the country today with one clear call: Bring back the 50 hostages, end the war,” the forum said.

By nightfall in Tel Aviv, Israel’s cultural and financial hub, massive crowds had down one of the city’s main boulevards and then gathered in the plaza now known as “Hostages Square.”

“The people demand: Stop the fire!” protesters chanted. “Refuse, refuse. Save the hostages!” they

yelled.

The calls came as Eyal Zamir, the chief of staff of the Israel Defense Forces, met with senior military commanders in Gaza on Sunday. “Today we are approving the plan for the next phase of the war,” which will focus on Gaza City, he said, according to an IDF

SEE ISRAEL ON A10

Gazan visitors: U.S. pauses visas, including for medical care. **A10**

Frustrated by health costs, some leave U.S.

Americans who faced crippling debt, lack of coverage move abroad

BY KELLY KASULIS CHO

Jennifer Sontag cracked her skull and couldn’t afford emergency brain surgery. Her doctors suggested she start a GoFundMe.

“Their advice was: ‘You’ve got to get the surgery. You’ll work it out later,’” she said. “And I’m like: ‘Are you kidding me? Your advice to someone in a medical crisis is to beg for money?’”

Sontag, 52, was teaching business management in China in 2019 when she fell while exiting a bus and hit her head so hard that it caused a leak of cerebral fluid in her brain. She spent five days in a hospital in Shanghai before her worried family persuaded her to get the necessary surgery close to them in St. Louis.

Her hospital bill in China came out to roughly \$1,300, she said. In Missouri, she negotiated the price of her operation down to about \$100,000, resigning herself to a

SEE HEALTH CARE ON A13

A plantation’s descendants take on slavery’s legacy

Black and White families strike a deal, creating a reconciliation-focused nonprofit in Alabama

BY EMMANUEL FELTON

HARPERSVILLE, ALA. — Word travels fast in this small town, so when Theoangelo Perkins heard that the family of Bill Parker was visiting his grave, he jumped in his car and raced to the old cemetery.

The burial ground is divided into two parts. Parker was laid to rest near the entrance with other members of the White family whose ancestors, named Wallace, once owned this land and were the second-largest enslavers in Shelby County. Nearby lies a much larger area, where the Black people who worked the land, as enslaved people or sharecroppers, and their descendants have been buried for more than a century.

For decades, the Black families maintained their portion of the private cemetery and the White descendants of the Wallace family took care of theirs. But in the early 2000s, Parker put up a fence that blocked access to the Black portion of the cemetery, local residents say, though none know exactly why.

With Parker’s family back in town on that day in 2018, Perkins hoped to persuade them to open the fence gate.

“My grandparents are buried at that cemetery. My great-grandparents are there. My great-great-grandparents are buried there. I have a great-



MICHAEL S. WILLIAMSON/THE WASHINGTON POST

Peter Datcher, surrounded by memorabilia, sits in his grandmother’s home in Harpersville, Alabama.

great-great-grandmother who’s buried there,” said Perkins, who is Harpersville’s mayor and the pastor of a local church. “And when I was small, my dad, my granddad and I would keep the cemetery up — at least the Black section of it.”

At the cemetery, Perkins con-

fronted Nell Gottlieb, Parker’s cousin, who inherited the Wallace plantation house and had clear memories of spending parts of her childhood there. Her views of the South had shifted dramatically since she moved away from Alabama more than 60 years ago. As Perkins told her

and her relatives about the pain caused by not being able to visit the Black graves in the cemetery, she felt deeply ashamed.

The family quickly agreed to stop blocking access.

Gottlieb asked what else they could do to try to make up for the

SEE PLANTATION ON A6

Shooting in Texas tied to left-wing activism

July attack outside ICE facility is part of increase in anti-fascist violence

BY ROBERT KLEMKO

DALLAS — Just after dusk on July 5, the crash of wood and metal suddenly reverberated through a predominantly Black and Latino neighborhood here known as The Bottoms. Neighbors peered out to see a small army of men in desert camouflage and tactical vests crouched behind a black armored vehicle, shouting commands toward a brick house.

A SWAT team had smashed through the front door of the residence, which neighbors say was occupied by several transgender women, part of a group of activists who initially united around trans and queer identity issues. Now, the women, dressed in bathrobes and pajamas, were being detained at gunpoint, neighbors said.

“It was weird enough that six or seven White, trans people

SEE ICE ON A4

IN THE NEWS

Trump’s D.C. The president primarily sees the city from his armored limousine. A team of reporters retraced some of his likely routes with the goal of seeing his view firsthand. **A8**

Medicaid cuts The One Big Beautiful Bill and budget challenges are imperiling the future of the health care program in North Carolina. **A3**

THE NATION **Sheep’s wool** and human hair could hold a key ingredient in up-grading toothpaste. **A2** **Florida GOP** “Deport Depot” merchandise was scrapped after Home Depot objected. **A5**

THE WORLD **The Sorbs,** a German national minority, are trying to save their vanishing language, which is threatened by assimilation and overt hostility from ultranationalists. **A9**

THE ECONOMY **The post-pandemic** slump in commercial real estate is now showing up in local government tax rolls. **A16**

STYLE **A musical** about Luigi Mangione, the accused killer of a health insurance CEO, is playing to sellout crowds. **B1**

What do Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce talk about? Now we know, thanks to the singer’s appearance on the NFL star’s podcast. **B1**

THE REGION **A guide** to the upcoming academic year, including policy changes at D.C.-area schools. **C7**

Adults are getting in on summer reading challenges via the D.C. Public Library. **C7**

HEALTH & SCIENCE **An anti-sunscreen** movement is growing on social media and causing concern among dermatologists, who warn of long-term health risks. **E1**

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